

Northstar Insurance - Prior Authorization Denial

Date: March 28, 2026

Member: Robert K. Lee

Member ID: NS-77881266

Date of Birth: October 3, 1984

Plan: Northstar Gold PPO

Ordering Provider: Dr. Samir Patel, MD (Neurology)

Dear Mr. Lee:

Your request for an MRI of the brain with and without contrast (CPT 70553) has been DENIED.

Reason for denial: Request does not meet medical necessity criteria for advanced imaging in the evaluation of headache per Northstar Imaging Policy IMG-HEAD-v7. The submitted documentation does not demonstrate presence of red-flag features or failure of first-line management sufficient to justify advanced imaging at this time.

Denial code: IMG-N-04 (insufficient clinical red flags documented).

You have the right to appeal. Appeals must reference the specific red-flag criteria in policy IMG-HEAD-v7 and include supporting clinical documentation.

Northstar Insurance

Utilization Management